Alcovia: Approach and Execution Plan

Product, Systems and Analytics Lead assignment

> **In one line:** earn the teen's daily visit first, and let the data the dashboards need arrive on its own.

1. How I see Alcovia

What it is and what it needs. Alcovia mentors teenagers through advisors, workshops, pods and an app. The program is the product. The app is how it stays inside a student's day and how Alcovia sees what is happening. Parents want to know their child is on track. Students want to know what to do today. The business needs students who stay engaged, advisors who coach from data instead of documents, and growth it can account for. All three run on the same data, so one weak link (numbers nobody trusts) hurts everything. I want Alcovia to be the first app a student opens after school and the first message a parent reads on a Sunday.

> Right numbers → families trust them → students come back → more real data → better coaching → families stay. This is why fixing the data comes before adding features.

My stance on the core tension. The dashboards need data, and data only exists if students use the app. But today the app gives a teen no reason to open it and asks them to log everything by hand. So the product has to earn its place in a teen's day first, and the data follows. I would rather ship a small thing students use than a complete thing nobody opens. Nothing gets typed that the system could learn. And I fix it before I add.

Who	What they want	How they behave
Student (user)	What to do today, and to see effort count	Opens Home and the Realm daily. Drops Study and Wellness within a week (2 of 13 active students used either this week). Busy with school and coaching.
Parent (user)	Progress without chasing anyone	Hears about progress at parent-teacher meetings a few times a year. Will not open another app unless it is easy.
Advisor (our staff)	To coach, not dig through documents	Runs a weekly review per student. Not a subject expert, so cannot judge schoolwork.
Alcovia team	How the app and program are doing	Needs usage, delivery and feedback numbers.

Assumptions (the brief does not say, so week 1 checks each):

- Students are in class 9 to 12 across CBSE, ICSE and IB, and many share a phone. Public data points that way but is rural-heavy, so Alcovia's own numbers come first.
- The 20 students who used the app in 45 days are the active base, not everyone enrolled.
- A website version of the app exists or is built as part of this work, and parent, advisor and student roles exist.
- School marks reach us by photo (no school API). The chapter question banks can be used.
- From 1 November the team is me, one full stack engineer and one process designer. Dashboard data is dummy and prices are placeholders, apart from the ₹3,999 workshop seat.

2. The Problems(in order)

#	Problem	Treatment
1	**Problem 4:** the student dashboard. Weekly reviews run on documents, and parents see nothing between meetings.	3.1. The main bet.
2	**Problem 3:** a process so every OKR hits its metric.	3.2
3	**Problem 1:** app usage from 2.15 to 30 minutes.	3.3
4	**Problem 2:** the GTM tracker.	3.4
5	**Schools:** real marks and a growth channel.	3.5

Why this order. Problem 4 is where families get value. It runs on data that comes from students using the app, so the parts of Problem 1 that feed it (right numbers, one-tap logging, a clear Home) come with it. Problem 3 decides how everything gets built. Problem 2 is internal and can start basic. Schools pay off over a term, not a week.

What I would not do: reset everyone's coins; build hard-mode puzzles; use AI calls to reach parents; build the advisor screen first; rank every student publicly; trust tick boxes students fill in; automate GTM numbers before the weekly ones are stable; or build a separate dashboard for each viewer.

3. Deep Dives

Each covers the problem, why it is harder than it looks, my approach, the risks and what I would test.

3.1 Problem 4: The Student Dashboard

The problem. Every week each student is reviewed, but the notes live in documents and ClickUp folders. Nobody sees how students do on average and a parent hears nothing between meetings. The brief wants KPIs on three lenses (did Alcovia run it, did students like it, how did they perform), a design, a timeline, a home for it, and data with little typing.

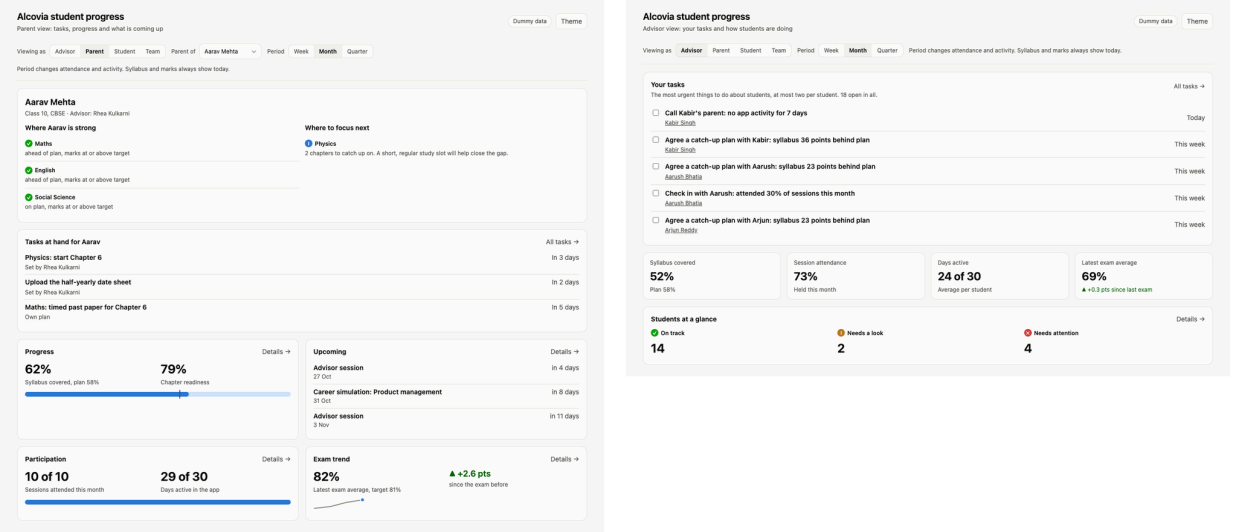
Why it is harder than it looks. A dashboard is only as good as its data, and logging 144 chapters by hand is why the numbers cannot be trusted today. The real marks live in schools and coaching centres with no API. Advisors are not subject experts, so they cannot judge content. And the users are parents and students, but advisors verify marks and set tasks, so skipping the advisor side leaves the family screens empty.

My approach

- **Users first.** Parents and students get the most care. Advisors are our staff and get a working minimum (student list, their tasks, verify marks). The team view comes last.
- **Each viewer gets a two-minute view, and the first screen shows only what matters.** Depth sits one screen down.

Viewer	First screen	One screen down
Student, parent	Strengths and where to focus. Tasks. Progress. Upcoming sessions and exams. Participation. Exam trend.	Progress by subject and chapter. Attendance and activity. Next five weeks. Marks over time vs target.
Advisor	Their tasks (top 5, at most 2 per student). Four numbers. Students on track.	All tasks. All students. A review page per student with cohort averages.
Alcovia team	Engaged minutes vs goal. Weekly active. Ratings. Sessions delivered.	Engagement by week. Adoption by feature. Delivery and feedback.

- **Progress is two numbers:** syllabus covered against a plan of 25% a quarter, and chapter readiness (practice above 70%, a timed past paper, exam accuracy of 80% or more). A chapter counts as done when the student passes a short quiz on it, which makes it proof and not a tick box.
- **Parents see strengths and where to focus, never a scolding,** only their own child, only marks an advisor has verified, and wellness only if the advisor shares it. Quantity and quality (did we run it, did they like it) are for our team.
- **Almost no typing.** App activity goes to a central store through n8n. In-person attendance uses a time-limited link tied to a code shown in the room. Ratings are one tap. Marks come from a photo that an advisor checks in the weekly review, and stay hidden from families until then. The rule: nothing is typed twice, and nothing is typed by someone who was not there.
- **It lives inside the app families already have, plus a website version,** so nobody learns a new link and advisors can review on a laptop. The KPIs for every item in the brief are in the appendix.



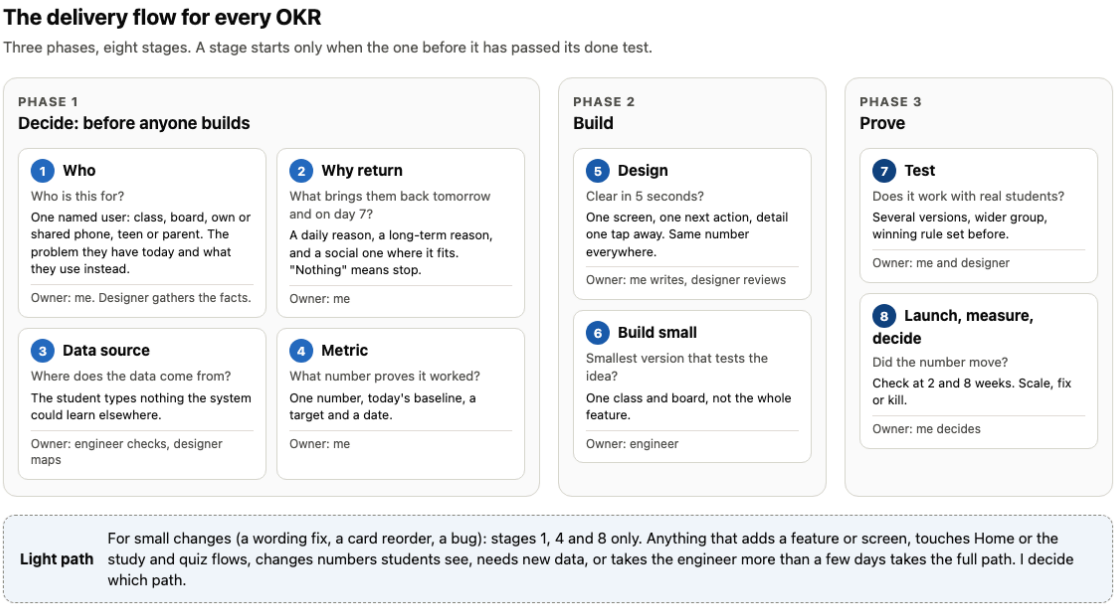
Left: parent view, first screen (the student sees the same, worded as "you"). Right: advisor view, first screen.

Risks and tests. Families may not open it, so a weekly summary with a link to the child's screen goes out through n8n. With about 20 students one student moves the average, so each student is also shown against their own target. I would test the weekly family open rate with and without the summary link, two versions of the first screen split by pod (winner fixed in advance as 10 points higher open rate), and advisor review prep time before and after.

3.2 Problem 3: How every OKR gets the best chance of hitting its metric

The problem. Alcovia struggles to ship things that work, give insight and put little load on teens and parents. The brief wants a flow I can run with two other people so each new OKR (a feature, an analytics upload, anything) hits its success metric. An OKR is an objective plus the few numbers that prove it was reached.

Why it is harder than it looks. Features get built for a user who may not exist: younger children often share a phone and older ones are busy with coaching. ASER 2023 found 89% of 14 to 18 year olds have a smartphone at home but only 31% of those who can use one own it. That is rural-heavy, and urban parents report higher access (LocalCircles), so for Alcovia's families I do not know. Home also shows about nine equal cards and no next step. And a three-person team skips a heavy process the first time something is urgent.



The flow. A stage starts only when the one before it has passed its done test.

Stage	Passes when	What goes wrong at Alcovia, and the fix
1. Who	A named user (class, board, phone), a problem they have, and what they use instead.	Under class 10 often shares a phone. Fix: a one-page day-one sheet.
2. Why return	A daily, a long-term and a social reason to come back are written down.	Study and Wellness lose students within a week. Coins reward nothing (202,942 against achievements of 50 to 2,000).
3. Data source	Every number has a named source. The student types nothing the system could learn.	144 chapters to log by hand. Home says 13% syllabus, Academics 6%. Fix: CBSE and ICSE presets.
4. Metric	One number, baseline, target and date, before design starts.	Success set without a baseline or date.
5. Design	Clear in 5 seconds. One next action. Same number everywhere.	Home is a report card: "Daily Velocity 0.4%/1.33%", "ON TRACK" at 0 of 59 hours.
6. Build small	Works end to end for one class and board.	A whole feature at once reaches every student. Fix: one board first.
7. Test	Versions tried, winning rule fixed beforehand.	Too few students to test everything. Fix: singles, then pairs, then the best bundle, split by pod.
8. Decide	Checked at 2 and 8 weeks. Scale, fix or kill, recorded.	Failed features stay as clutter. Fix: killed features are removed.

Why "why return" is second. A feature built for the right person that gives no reason to come back is tried once and dropped, which is what happened to the Syllabus (10 students opened it, 1 used it this week). I own the "who" gate, not the engineer or the designer, because it needs someone who can say no. **Testing combinations:** five features is 32 groups, so I test singles, then pairs, then the best bundle. I rejected testing every combination because no result would be clear with a small base.

Running it. Each OKR is one ClickUp card with the eight stages as a checklist, a 20 minute planning check on Mondays and a 30 minute metrics review on Fridays. **Light path:** small changes (a wording fix, a bug) take stages 1, 4 and 8 only. A new feature or screen, anything touching Home or the study and quiz flows, anything that changes numbers students see, needs new data or takes more than a few days of engineer

time takes the full path. I decide which. **Risk and test:** overhead for a team of three. I would run the first real OKR (the chapter quiz) through the full path, note where it felt heavy, and cut it.

3.3 Problem 1: App usage from 2.15 to 30 minutes a day

The problem. The app is stable but average use is 2.15 minutes a day against a goal of 30. In 45 days 20 students used it, 11 to 17 a week, and 7 have not opened it in two weeks. Everyone uses Home and 13 use the Realm. 11 opened the focus timer and only 5 use it regularly. 1 connected WHOOP.

Why it is harder than it looks. Active time alone cannot reach 30 minutes: without a focus mode students top out around 13 to 20, with a verified focus mode about 40 is possible, so the recommendation follows the second case. Focus time can be faked, so only verified focus counts. And this is mostly a logic problem, not a bug problem. I went through the app screen by screen. It is deep and polished, and its parts do not fit together. Calling it "basic" would be wrong.

What is wrong today, logical and technical:

Issue	Type	What I saw	Fixed by
Home built for the advisor, not the teen	Logical	Red 69% attendance, 13% syllabus, jargon, about nine equal cards, a tour to learn the app. No next step.	Home rebuild, weeks 2 to 5
Same number, different values	Logical	Syllabus 13% on Home, 6% on Academics. Physics at 0 of 4 chapters shows 19%. "Math" and "Mathematics" both listed.	One source, weeks 2 to 3
Rewards are worthless	Logical	202,942 coins against achievements of 50 to 2,000. The 100-day streak reward is an extra "Litmus Test". Odd progress such as "2/1 territories".	Coin fix, after week 8
Game and study do not talk	Logical	Only the focus timer feeds the game. The Realm is behind a corner button and Rankings is hidden inside it. Dozens of castles for about 20 players.	Study feeds the game, pods as teams
Logging is a chore, tasks are stale	Logical	144 chapters, 5+ tasks each, 5 status levels. 52 overdue tasks, goals from 31 May. Actual focus hours stay at 0.0.	One-tap marking, tasks rebuilt from the plan
Home error, slow Realm, wrong icons	Technical	"Couldn't load your habit analysis" (maybe a test-account artefact). Realm blank on first load, labels overlap. A YouTube row with a book icon.	Engineer audit, week 1; small fixes later

My approach: one number, engaged minutes per student per day, active time plus verified focus, reported separately so one cannot hide a fall in the other. A 30 minute day at week 8 could be: Home and tasks 2, marking a chapter and its quiz 2, the Realm 3, the Daily Puzzle 2 (about 9 active), plus about 21 of verified focus, which is one 25 minute session on most days. These minutes are illustrative.

Focus counts only when verified: the app stays in the foreground, no long idle stretch, and a one-tap check-in at the end. The app already fails a session if you leave and charges 50 coins for giving up, close to Forest, where leaving kills the tree. Opal and one sec go further on iOS through Apple's Screen Time API, so a full lock mode is possible later.

Daily Puzzle, a break and not more study. One a day, as Wordle does, so it stays something to look forward to. Easy mode only, because the aim is a 5 to 10 minute win and not frustration. It unlocks only after a focus session, and that gate plus a pod leaderboard is what makes it Alcovia's. It is not tied to the syllabus, because it should feel like rest, and it makes no "brain training" claims (Lumosity was fined by the US FTC in 2016 for them). **Coins:** add sinks, hand out fewer and drop the Litmus Test reward. I rejected a reset because it breaks trust with students who earned them. **Re-engagement is a person:** on day 3 the pod and advisor nudge the student, on day 7 the advisor calls the parent. I rejected an AI call because parents of a premium program expect a person.

Order, risks, tests. Right numbers, a simpler Home, study feeding the game, the one-tap check-in and the chapter quiz come first because Problem 4 runs on them. The puzzle, coins, pods and re-engagement follow after week 8, with advisors checking on quiet students by hand. The risks are gaming, a coaching load that

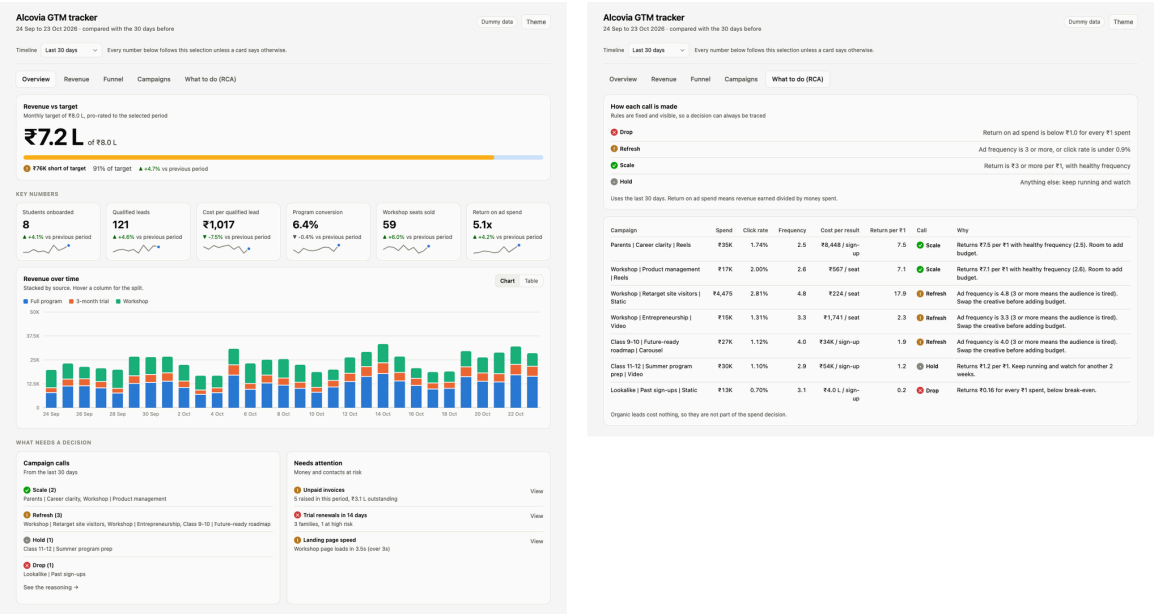
leaves no room for focus, and the puzzle becoming a chore. I would test the puzzle gate against no gate on focus sessions a week, and two versions of Home split by pod.

3.4 Problem 2: The GTM tracker

The problem. Scale-up needs accountability: revenue against target (trials against full program, workshop revenue at ₹3,999 a seat, unpaid invoices, renewals), the Meta ads funnel from lead to architect session, campaign performance, and the analysis to decide which campaigns to drop, refresh or scale.

Why it is harder than it looks. About 7 students a month means conversion jumps around, so one week proves nothing. Without a source tag on every lead in ClickUp, cost per qualified lead and campaign calls are guesses. And a dashboard has to say what to do, not only what the numbers are.

My approach. One general dashboard, as the brief asks, with the month's decisive numbers on the first tab and detail a tab down. A timeline selector (7, 30, 90, 180 days or the month so far) changes every number. Campaign calls (Scale, Refresh, Hold, Drop) use rules shown on the page and always use at least 30 days of data, because 7 days is too thin to move ad budget. I rejected a separate dashboard per viewer as too much for the scope. Real data comes from Razorpay (seats, invoices), Meta Ads (spend, clicks, frequency) and ClickUp (lead stages, renewals): weekly exports by the designer from week 3, automated through n8n after a stable month.



Left: Overview tab (30 days). Right: the campaign calls, with the reason written next to each. Dummy data.

Risks and tests. The thresholds are my placeholders (drop below ₹1 returned per ₹1 spent, refresh at ad frequency 3 or more or click rate under 0.9%, scale at ₹3 or more) and must come from real results. Source tagging is set up in week 1. I would run the weekly numbers by hand for a month, check the dashboard's calls against what happened to each campaign, and only then automate.

3.5 Connecting with Schools

The problem. The real marks and syllabus live in schools, and advisors are not subject experts. Most mid-tier schools have no app, so parents hear about progress at parent-teacher meetings a few times a year (my own experience of school). Alcovia can show progress every week.

Why it is harder than it looks. Teachers have 40 or more students and no reason to help us. School sales cycles are slow, schools with an ERP are harder to plug into, a school channel can dilute a premium brand, and mid-tier parents may not afford the program. As far as I know Mindler and iDreamCareer already sell

career guidance through schools, and Teachmint grew through owner-run private schools, which is why I would start there. I would check both before relying on them.

Step	What happens	When
1. No partnership	School facts reach us through families: a photo of marks, the exam date sheet, report cards, and advisor notes from parent-teacher meetings.	Weeks 2 to 5
2. Pilot, 2 or 3 mid-tier schools	Alcovia runs a career workshop in the school and invites interested families. With written consent, a teacher sends marks and chapters covered once a month through a one-minute form. The advisor stays the coach.	Talks from week 6, pilot after week 8
3. Scale	Where a school has an ERP, facts flow in automatically. Schools become a repeatable lead source.	After the pilot

What it fixes and how I would know. Real marks with almost no typing for Problem 4 (I rejected asking teachers to update progress themselves: no time, and they only see classroom work); a tagged lead source for Problem 2; and families who already understand the program for Problem 1. I would measure schools piloted, workshop attendees, qualified leads, conversion to the 3-month trial, and the share of marks that come from a teacher instead of a photo.

4. The Eight Week Plan

One engineer is the bottleneck and almost everything needs one, so order matters more than length. **Me:** priorities, the "who" and "why return" calls, specs, testing with families and schools, the metrics review. **Engineer:** app audit, the fixes, the family and advisor screens, the website version. **Process designer:** data mapping, ClickUp flows, the attendance link, the marks upload flow, quiz mapping, GTM exports, school consent forms.

Weeks	Me	Engineer	Process designer
1. Decide	Day-one sheet. First four gates. Talk to 5 or 6 families.	Audit data model, roles, website version, why numbers disagree.	Map data sources. CBSE class 10 chapters, question-bank licensing. Source tagging.
2 to 3. Fix	Spec Home and the four blocks. Prototype with 3 to 5 families.	One source for numbers, merge subjects, one-tap marking, CBSE preset, central store and n8n.	Attendance link. Marks upload and verify flow. ClickUp task sync.
4 to 5. Build	Test with more families. Two versions, split by pod.	Student and parent screens (app and website). Minimal advisor view.	Quiz-to-chapter mapping. Flag-to-task rules. Weekly review routine.
6 to 7. Quiz, widen	Review pilot. Open talks with 2 or 3 schools.	Chapter quiz pilot. ICSE preset. Weekly parent summary.	Next board's syllabus. GTM exports continue.
8. Prove	Check metrics. Scale, fix or kill.	Basic team view.	Prepare numbers for the review.

What starts as basic. Family screens get full focus. Advisor and team views start as a working minimum, and the GTM tracker stays on dummy data while the designer pulls real numbers weekly from week 3. Coins, pods and re-engagement wait until after week 8. Each basic item has a trigger to build it up, such as engaged minutes stalling or a month of stable weekly numbers. **Later:** a full phone-lock focus mode, wearables beyond WHOOP, Realm cities tied to real goals, workshop clips in the app, and badges for summer-program applications, which only carry weight once real activity stands behind them. **Day-one checks:** class, board, phone and enrolment for every student; whether a website version and the roles exist;

where the 13% and 6% numbers come from; whether the question banks can be used; and whether the weekly review is one student at a time.

5. Risks

- **The engineer is the bottleneck in weeks 2 to 5.** Only the Problem 1 items that feed Problem 4 come first.
- **Data trust.** One wrong number and parents stop believing the rest. The same-number check and advisor verification are the guard.
- **"Basic" becomes "forgotten".** Every basic item has a minimum standard and a written trigger.
- **Families may not open it.** The weekly summary with a direct link, and the weekly open rate tells us.
- **A small base.** About 20 active students means results are directional until it grows.
- **Minors' data.** Access is by role, wellness is opt-in, schools give written consent.
- **My assumptions may be wrong** (class, board, phone, website version, roles). Week 1 checks them before anything is built on them.

6. Success Metrics

> **Main metric: engaged minutes per student per day** (active time plus verified focus). It starts at 2.15 and the goal is 30. It only rises when the product is worth opening and the focus is real, and every dashboard runs on the data it produces.

Metric	Role
Weekly family open rate	Do parents and students use the dashboard?
Chapters updated within 7 days	Can the data be trusted?
Advisor review prep time	Is the weekly review faster than digging through documents?
Weekly active students (13 of 20 now), regular focus users (5 now)	The people behind the main number.
Wrong-number reports, overdue advisor tasks, attendance-link misuse, session ratings	Guardrails: must not get worse.

I rejected simpler choices. **Minutes alone** can be padded, so only verified focus counts. **Dashboard opens alone** can rise from curiosity. **Syllabus percentage alone** is self-reported unless a quiz backs it. **Ratings alone** come from a small sample. With about 20 students every target is directional until the base grows.

7. Closing

Alcovia has a deep app and a strong program. What it lacks is a way for the two to talk without asking a teenager to do data entry. I would fix the numbers, give students a reason to come back, let the data arrive on its own, and show parents progress every week instead of a few times a year. I would build the family screens first, keep the rest basic until it earns more, and run everything through a process that asks "who is this for, and why will they come back" before anyone writes code. If a test proves me wrong, the numbers will show it. But I would bet on respecting the student's time.

Appendix:

For each thing in the brief I define one measure per lens: **quantity** (did Alcovia run it), **quality** (did the student like it), **performance** (how did the student do). Quantity and quality are for our team. Families see performance and participation.

What the student goes through	Quantity	Quality	Student performance
Daily: timetable	Students with a timetable set	One-tap weekly: did it help?	Planned study slots kept
8pm quiz, focus time	Quizzes run; focus mode working	One-tap rating	Days taken, average score; verified focus minutes
Active minutes and recovery	Students with a wearable connected	Not asked (optional)	Active minutes, sleep and recovery vs own baseline
Weekly: advisor session, academic roadmap	Sessions held vs planned	Student and parent rating	Syllabus vs plan, chapter readiness, task completion, deadline adherence, time estimation accuracy
Monthly: workshops, pod, peer session, mentor call, branding shoot	Held vs planned	Rating out of 5	Attendance; facilitator soft-skill scores (engagement, teamwork, crisis management, adaptability, public speaking, communication)
Syllabus re-evaluation	Done vs due	Not asked	Adherence to the study rigour
Quarterly: podcast, competition prep, parent-child and out-of-city workshops, theme (social work, entrepreneurship, summer programs)	Held vs planned; milestones set	Rating (parents rate the parent-child workshop)	Participation, competition result, milestones met, applications submitted
Roadmaps: career (done or not), personal (monthly milestones)	Created vs planned	Parent and student rating	Done or not done; milestones met
School exams	Not applicable	Not applicable	Marks vs target and trend. Targets set with each family per subject and exam type, reviewed monthly

Data	How it gets in
App activity (focus, tasks, chapters, quiz); online attendance; quiz scores	Automatic: the app to a central store through n8n; meeting export
In-person attendance	A link sent during the session: opens only for that session, unique per student, needs the room code. The facilitator ticks anyone without a phone.
Quality ratings; roadmap status; soft skills; teacher comments	One tap by the student; the advisor in the weekly review; a short facilitator scorecard; a tagged advisor note
School and coaching marks	Photo upload by student or parent. AI reads it and the advisor checks it weekly. Unverified, and hidden from families, until then.
Wearable data	Optional. "Not connected" is shown, never zero.